When finally released from army service, Jim joined the Ministry of Defence as a civil servant.While working in the city of Chester he joined an amateur dramatic production, in which he met local secretary Hilda Jones - recently returned from service abroad with the British Red Cross.

They married in February 1950, and soon afterwards went abroad, Jim being posted to the colony of Singapore. Because of the situation there at that time, he was required to be commissioned as an army officer. ('If only my old Sergeant could see me now!' he used to say to himself.)

A son, Martin, was born to them on Singapore in November 1951. A girl, Janet was born in 1954, soon after their return to England. There followed a posting to Perth, Scotland, then another to Nairobi, Kenya (1959 - 1962).

After this Hilda and Jim settled in the London suburb of Epsom, where they lived for nearly thirty years.

The war had obliged the academically gifted Jim to abandon his dream of being the first in his family to go to university, so he was very proud when both his children graduated.



Jim and three of the 9th Manchesters at Wetzeldorf Camp, Graz, Austria, February 1946



Left: in the officer class as last - Jim with Hilda, about 1950

Right: wedding to Hilda Jones from Chester, 1950



Jim retired from the Ministry of Defence in 1984, and he and Hilda returned to the Chester area. Here he was active in his local church. He also pursued his favourite hobbies of family history research, wine tasting, travel - and watching 'Dr Who'!

A grandson, Alexander James - Martin's son - was born in 1983.

Hilda died in February 2005, and Jim a few months later.

Martin is now retired after a career in local government, and lives in Manchester with his wife Liz.Janet had a career in journalism, and now lives in Sydney, Australia, with her husband Ian. She runs this website.



Above and below: Jim with Hilda and children Martin and Janet, around 1960 (possibly in Kenya)



Left: Jim baths new son Martin, Singapore, early fifties

